

School Homework Helper — Live Deployment Guide

Domain: www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com

Project: Next.js 15 (App Router) + Supabase + OpenAI

Date: June 2026

Important: Read This First

This website is built with **Next.js 15**, which requires **Node.js hosting**. It cannot run on standard PHP-only shared hosting without Node.js support.

Most Bluehost **shared cPanel** plans are PHP-focused. Before deploying on Bluehost directly, check your cPanel for:

- **Setup Node.js App** or **Node.js Selector**, OR
- **SSH access** with Node.js installed, OR
- A **VPS / Cloud** plan

Recommended approach: Deploy on **Vercel** (free tier works well for Next.js) and point your Bluehost domain DNS to Vercel. You keep your domain at Bluehost; Vercel hosts the app.

What You Need Before Going Live

1. Accounts & services

Item	Purpose
GitHub account	Store code for deployment
Vercel account (recommended)	Host Next.js app
Bluehost cPanel	Manage domain DNS
Supabase project	Auth + database
OpenAI API key	AI tools
Google Cloud Console	Google Sign-In OAuth
Google AdSense (optional)	Ads

2. Environment variables (production)

Set these in your hosting dashboard (Vercel → Settings → Environment Variables). **Never commit real keys to GitHub.**

Variable	Example / notes
OPENAI_API_KEY	Your OpenAI secret key
OPENAI_MODEL	gpt-4o-mini (optional)
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL	https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL	https://xxxxx.supabase.co

NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY	Supabase anon/public key
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY	Server-only; keep secret
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_CLIENT_ID	Optional — ca-pub-...
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_SLOT	Optional
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_SLOT_HORIZONTAL	Optional
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_SLOT_IN_ARTICLE	Optional

3. Supabase setup

1. Log in to supabase.com → your project.
2. Open **SQL Editor** and run `supabase/schema.sql` from this project.
3. Enable **Google OAuth**: Authentication → Providers → Google → Enable.
4. Add **Redirect URLs** (Authentication → URL Configuration):
 - `https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com/**`
 - `https://schoolhomeworkhelper.com/**`
 - `http://localhost:3000/**` (for local dev)
5. Copy **Project URL**, **anon key**, and **service_role key** for env vars.

4. Google OAuth (Sign-In)

1. Go to [Google Cloud Console](https://console.cloud.google.com).
2. Create OAuth 2.0 credentials (Web application).
3. **Authorized JavaScript origins**:
 - `https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com`
 - `https://schoolhomeworkhelper.com`
4. **Authorized redirect URIs**: (from Supabase → Auth → Google provider)
 - Usually: `https://YOUR_PROJECT.supabase.co/auth/v1/callback`
5. Paste Client ID and Secret into Supabase Google provider settings.

Option A — Recommended: Deploy on Vercel + Bluehost Domain

Step 1: Push code to GitHub

1. Create a new repository on GitHub (e.g. `school-homework-helper`).
2. Open terminal in your project folder:

```
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/school-homework-helper.git
git push -u origin main
```

Security: Ensure `.env.local` is in `.gitignore` and never pushed.

Step 2: Import project on Vercel

1. Go to vercel.com → Sign up / Log in (use GitHub).
2. Click **Add New** → **Project**.
3. Import your GitHub repository.
4. Framework: **Next.js** (auto-detected).
5. **Environment Variables:** Add all variables from the table above.
 - Set `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` to `https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com`
6. Click **Deploy**.
7. Wait for build to finish. You get a temporary URL like `your-app.vercel.app`.

Step 3: Add custom domain in Vercel

1. Vercel project → **Settings** → **Domains**.
2. Add:
 - `schoolhomeworkhelper.com`
 - `www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com`
3. Vercel shows DNS records to configure.

Step 4: Configure DNS in Bluehost cPanel

1. Log in to **Bluehost** → **cPanel**.
2. Open **Domains** → **Zone Editor** (or **DNS Zone Editor**).
3. Select `schoolhomeworkhelper.com`.
4. Add or update records:

Type	Host	Value	TTL
A	@	76.76.21.21	14400
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com	14400

5. **Remove** conflicting A/CNAME records for `@` or `www` pointing elsewhere.
6. Save changes.

Step 5: Wait for DNS & SSL

- DNS propagation: 15 minutes to 48 hours (often under 1 hour).
- Vercel automatically provisions **HTTPS (SSL)**.
- In Vercel Domains, set **www** as primary or redirect apex → `www` (your choice).

Step 6: Verify live site

Checklist:

- ☐ Homepage loads at `https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com`
- ☐ Logo, navigation, and footer display correctly
- ☐ Cookie banner appears; Accept/Reject works
- ☐ All 6 AI tools respond (after sign-in if guest limit reached)
- ☐ Google Sign-In works on `/signin`
- ☐ Privacy, Terms, and Cookie pages load
- ☐ Mobile layout looks correct on phone

Step 7: Post-deploy updates

Whenever you change code:

1. Commit and push to GitHub `main` branch.
2. Vercel auto-redeploys (if connected).
3. Or manually trigger **Redeploy** in Vercel dashboard.

Option B — Deploy on Bluehost (Node.js required)

Use this only if your Bluehost plan includes **Node.js App** setup or SSH with persistent Node.

Step 1: Confirm Node.js support

In cPanel, look for **Setup Node.js App** or contact Bluehost support to confirm Node 18+ is available.

Step 2: Upload project

Via SSH (recommended):

```
ssh your-user@your-server
cd ~
git clone https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/school-homework-helper.git
cd school-homework-helper
```

Via File Manager: Upload ZIP, extract in `home/youruser/`.

Step 3: Install & build

```
npm install
npm run build
```

Create `.env` or set env vars in cPanel Node app panel (same variables as Vercel list).

Step 4: Configure Node.js app in cPanel

1. **Setup Node.js App** → Create Application.
2. Node version: 18 or 20.
3. Application root: your project folder.
4. Application URL: your domain or subdomain.
5. Application startup file: configure to run `npm start` (runs `next start`).
6. Set all environment variables in the panel.
7. Start the application.

Step 5: Point domain

If app runs on a subdomain first, later map `www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com` to the Node app per Bluehost docs.

Note: Shared hosting often cannot run Next.js reliably. Vercel is strongly recommended.

Bluehost + Vercel: How It Works Together

Component	Where it lives
Domain registration	Bluehost

DNS records	Bluehost cPanel Zone Editor
Website hosting (Next.js)	Vercel
Database & Auth	Supabase
AI API	OpenAI

You do **not** need to upload PHP files from the `php/` folder if you deploy the Next.js app.

Troubleshooting

Site shows Bluehost default page

- DNS not updated yet, or old A record still points to Bluehost server IP.
- Wait and clear DNS cache; verify A/CNAME in Zone Editor.

Google Sign-In fails on live site

- Add production URLs in Supabase redirect allow list.
- Add origins in Google OAuth console.
- Ensure `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` matches your live URL exactly.

AI tools return errors

- Check `OPENAI_API_KEY` is set in Vercel/hosting env.
- Check OpenAI billing/credits.
- View Vercel **Functions** logs for API route errors.

Ads not showing

- AdSense must approve your site first.
- User must click **Accept** on cookie banner (ads load only after consent).
- Verify `NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_CLIENT_ID` starts with `ca-pub-` .

Build fails on Vercel

- Run `npm run build` locally first.
 - Fix TypeScript/lint errors.
 - Ensure all env vars are set in Vercel before deploy.
-

Quick Reference — Commands

Task	Command
Local development	<code>pnpm dev</code>
Production build (test)	<code>pnpm run build</code>
Run production locally	<code>pnpm start</code>
Lint	<code>pnpm run lint</code>

Support Contacts

- **Website email:** hello@schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- **Vercel docs:** <https://vercel.com/docs>
- **Supabase docs:** <https://supabase.com/docs>
- **Bluehost support:** Via Bluehost chat / help center

End of deployment guide — School Homework Helper